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handmade crochet patterns

# Willow the Bunny Lovey

A bunny comforter: a soft, firmly stuffed head above a light, drapey granny-square blanket. Long floppy ears to hold, an embroidered face with no small parts, and a blanket that grows evenly from the centre out.

No small parts

Advanced beginner

2 - 3 hours



### FINISHED SIZE

- Blanket about 26 cm (10 in) square (20 rounds).
- Head about 4.9 cm across; roughly 33 cm from ear tips to the opposite corner.
- DK cotton on a 3.5 mm hook (3.0 mm for the head if your tension is loose).

Design Code NS 10

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## PATTERN OVERVIEW

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Sizing the blanket: the square grows ~1.3 cm per side per round - 18 rounds ~23 cm, 20 rounds ~26 cm, 22 rounds ~28 cm. Add rounds to make a bigger lovey.

No small parts · Advanced beginner · 2 - 3 hours

### SAFETY FIRST

No safety eyes, buttons, beads or removable parts; the face is embroidered and every floss end is knotted inside the head. That is safer, but it is not a tested toy - do not describe Willow as "baby-safe" without ASTM F963 / EN 71 testing.

Comforters are not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months and should be used with supervision; put that in your listing. Sew every seam twice and weave ends in at least 5 cm. Say "embroidered face, no small parts" - a claim you can stand behind.

## MATERIALS

- Yarn: DK (#3) 100% cotton (or a baby-safe certified blend), about 60 g - cream, sage, dusty pink or pale grey. Only the head is stuffed.
- Hook: 3.5 mm (US E/4) for the blanket; use 3.0 mm for the head if your tension is loose.
- Eyes / floss: none - the face is embroidered in dark brown or charcoal cotton floss, ends knotted inside.
- Also: about 8 g fibre fill, tapestry needle, stitch marker.

## GAUGE

Gauge: about 4.3 mm per stitch and 3.8 mm per round. Check on the blanket after Rnd 3: 9 dc along an edge should measure ~39 mm; narrower and the blanket comes out small.

## ABBREVIATIONS

**MR** magic ring

**ch** chain

**sc** single crochet

**dc** double crochet

**inc** increase (2 sc in one st)

**dec** invisible decrease

**sl st** slip stitch

**st(s)** stitch(es)

**sp** space

**FO** fasten off

**(n)** stitch count at round end

## CONSTRUCTION & TECHNIQUES

The HEAD and EARS are worked in a continuous spiral (no joins, marker in the first stitch). The BLANKET is worked in JOINED rounds: each round closes with a slip stitch and the next begins with a turning chain - a different rhythm that lets the square grow out evenly. Work every stitch through both loops unless noted.

### 1. Magic ring & spiral

The head and each ear begin with a magic ring; pull the tail tight after round one.

### 2. The granny-square corner

Every blanket corner is (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into one corner space. Those four corners make the piece square instead of round. Miss one corner group and the whole square pulls out of true - check all four at the end of every round.

### 3. The border round

One final round of single crochet around the edge with 3 sc into each corner space squares the edge and stops the blanket curling. Do not skip it.

## INSTRUCTIONS

### 1. Head - worked top-down

| Rnd | Instruction           | Sts  | Note             |
|-----|-----------------------|------|------------------|
| R1  | 6 sc in MR            | (6)  | -                |
| R2  | inc in each st around | (12) | -                |
| R3  | [sc, inc] x 6         | (18) | -                |
| R4  | [2 sc, inc] x 6       | (24) | ears at R4 - R6  |
| R5  | [3 sc, inc] x 6       | (30) | -                |
| R6  | [4 sc, inc] x 6       | (36) | full width       |
| R7  | sc in each st around  | (36) | -                |
| R8  | sc in each st around  | (36) | face on R8 - R10 |
| R9  | sc in each st around  | (36) | -                |
| R10 | [4 sc, dec] x 6       | (30) | -                |
| R11 | [3 sc, dec] x 6       | (24) | stuff firmly     |
| R12 | [2 sc, dec] x 6       | (18) | -                |
| R13 | [sc, dec] x 6         | (12) | top up stuffing  |
| R14 | dec x 6               | (6)  | close            |

FO and close with the tail. The finished head is about 4.9 cm across and 5.3 cm tall. Stuff it FIRMLY - a soft head collapses when gripped and the face distorts.

### 2. Ears - long and floppy (make 2, do not stuff)

| Rnd | Instruction   | Sts | Note |
|-----|---------------|-----|------|
| R1  | 6 sc in MR    | (6) | -    |
| R2  | [sc, inc] x 3 | (9) | -    |

| Rnd         | Instruction                  | Sts         | Note        |
|-------------|------------------------------|-------------|-------------|
| <b>R3</b>   | [2 sc, inc] x 3              | <b>(12)</b> | -           |
| <b>R4-8</b> | sc in each st around (5 rnd) | <b>(12)</b> | -           |
| <b>R9</b>   | [2 sc, dec] x 3              | <b>(9)</b>  | -           |
| <b>R10</b>  | sc in each st around         | <b>(9)</b>  | -           |
| <b>R11</b>  | [sc, dec] x 3                | <b>(6)</b>  | flatten, FO |

Flatten and FO with a long tail. Sew to Rnds 4-6 of the head, about 10 stitches apart, pinching each base so it flops forward.

### 3. Blanket - granny square, joined rounds

Ch 4 and sl st to the first ch to form a ring. Every round closes with a slip stitch into the top of the starting ch-3.

| Rnd              | Instruction                                                                                                                                                                       | Sts         | Note                   |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|------------------------|
| <b>Rnd 1</b>     | ch 3 (counts as first dc), 2 dc in the ring, [ch 2, 3 dc in the ring] x 3, ch 2, sl st to the ch-3 top                                                                            | <b>(12)</b> | 12 dc, 4 corner spaces |
| <b>Rnd 2</b>     | sl st into the next corner space; ch 3, 2 dc in that space, ch 2, 3 dc in the same space (first corner); then (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) into each remaining corner space; sl st to close | <b>(24)</b> | +12 dc                 |
| <b>Rnds 3-20</b> | into every corner space work (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc), and into every space along a side work 3 dc; sl st to close. Each round adds one 3-dc group to every side (+12 dc per round)     | -           | see dc table           |

Total dc per round: Rnd 3 = 36, Rnd 5 = 60, Rnd 10 = 120, Rnd 15 = 180, Rnd 20 = 240 (60 dc per edge = ~26 cm).

Border: work one final round of sc all the way around - 1 sc into each dc, and 3 sc into each corner space (into the space itself; the 2 corner chains are not worked into) - then sl st to join and FO. At Rnd 20 that is 240 sc + 12 corner sc = 252 sc. This firms the edge and stops the square curling.

Open dc clusters and crisp (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) corners keep the square true round after round.



On the hook - what your rounds should look like as they grow

## FINISHING & ASSEMBLY

- **Face (embroidery only):** two small oval eyes about 8 stitches apart across Rnds 8-9, a small inverted-triangle nose centred between and below them, and a shallow Y for the mouth. KNOT every end inside the head and bury the tails before closing. Skip blush - chalk rubs off on bedding and is not washable.
- **Joining:** centre the head over one corner of the square, overlapping the blanket by about 3 cm. Sew all the way around the base of the head, THEN sew it a second time - this is the only structural seam and it will be pulled, chewed and washed. Weave every end in at least 5 cm.

## TROUBLESHOOTING

- **Blanket curls / not square.**

You skipped the sc border, or missed a (3 dc, ch 2, 3 dc) corner - check all four corners at the end of every round.

- **Came out too small / head flops.**

Tighter than 4.3 mm/dc: go up a hook or add rounds (22 rounds = ~28 cm). Stuff the head firmly and sew the base seam twice.

## COLORWAYS



Cream



Sage



Dusty pink



Pale grey



Butter yellow

## HELPFUL TIPS

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### For your listing

Materials: 100% cotton, embroidered face, no safety eyes, no buttons, beads or removable parts.

Care: machine wash cool on a gentle cycle inside a mesh bag; reshape while damp and dry flat. Do not tumble dry - it will felt and shrink.

Supervision: comforters are not recommended in the cot for babies under 12 months; use with supervision.

- Colorways: cream, sage, dusty pink, pale grey and butter yellow - neutrals outsell brights in the baby category.

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### Safety reminder

Willow has NO safety eyes, buttons, beads or removable parts - the face is embroidered and floss ends are knotted inside the head. Even so she is not a tested toy (ASTM F963 / EN 71): do not claim "baby-safe". Comforters are not recommended in a cot for babies under 12 months and should be used with supervision; sew every seam twice and weave ends in at least 5 cm.

## Happy crocheting!

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